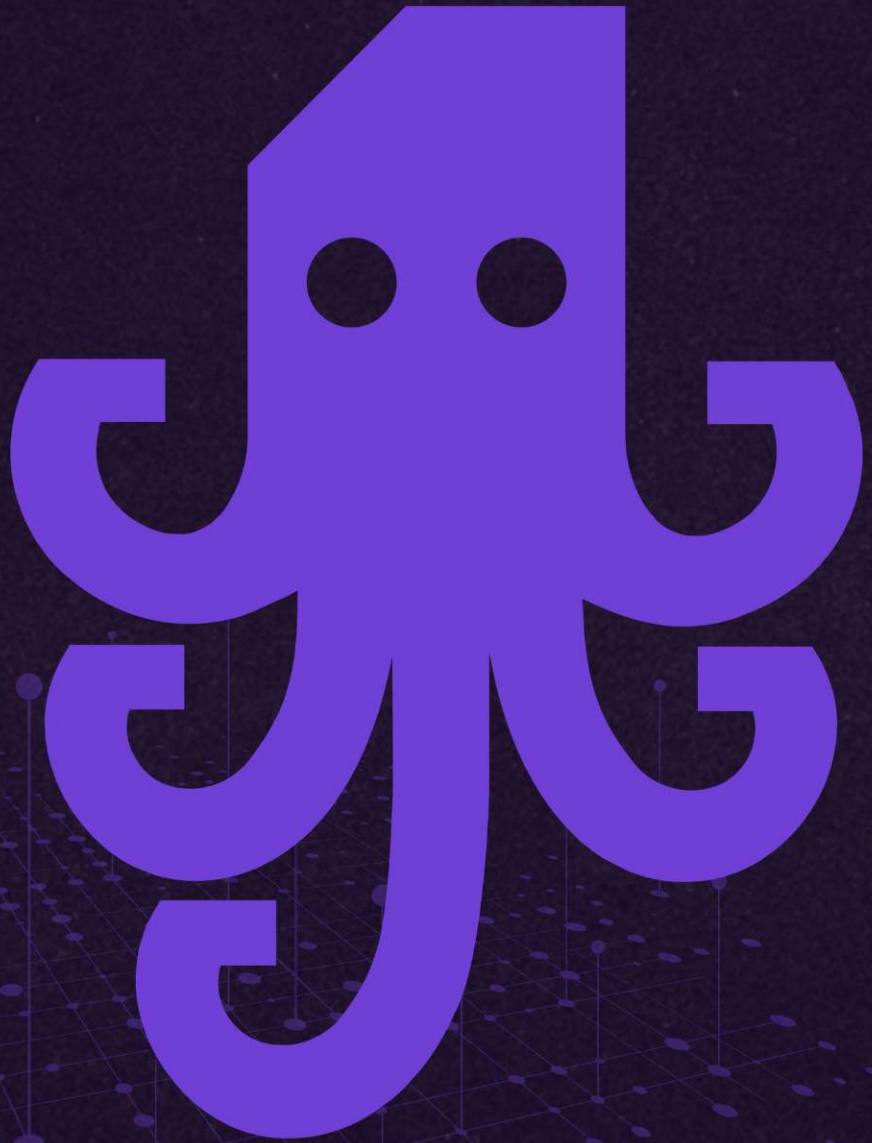


| docusrch

| Student Affiliate Program Proposal



AM>

| AMERICAN MARKETING
ASSOCIATION

2025

Table of Contents

01

Introduction

02

*Understanding the
Target Audience*

03

Affiliate Models

04

*Strategic
Implementation*

05

*Performance
Measurement*

06

*Marketing &
Promotion*

07

*Future Growth
& Adaptation*

08

Conclusion

09

Appendix

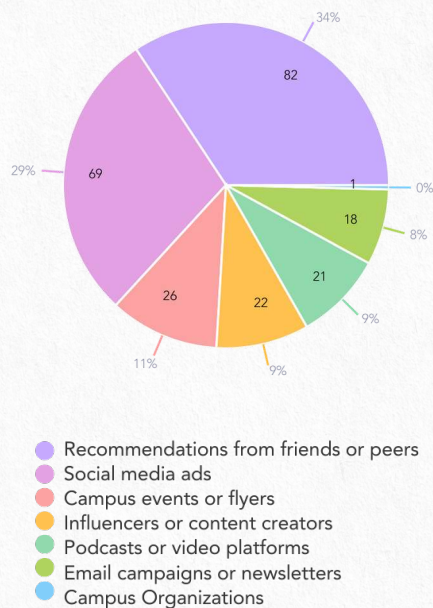
Introduction

This report presents the docusrch Student Affiliate Proposal, which outlines strategies for building brand awareness and driving adoption of the docusrch platform through student engagement. By empowering students as brand affiliates, the proposed models aim to create a sense of community, increase platform usage, and establish docusrch as an essential research tool for all academic communities.

The proposed affiliate models are designed to recruit students across various campus communities to promote docusrch, offering incentives for content creation, peer recommendations, and direct outreach. Since research has demonstrated the importance of peer recommendations in trying new tools, student affiliates are key. Through hands-on engagement with research labs, student organizations, and academic departments, affiliates will play a key role in increasing usage and connections. This proposal explores three distinct affiliate models: a) Knowledge Pioneers, b) deepsrch Creators, and c) Papertrail. Each model supports the program's goal of creating a consistent and accessible affiliate network.

Understanding the Target Audience

Exhibit 3: How Students Discover Academic Tools



The affiliate models are designed for undergraduate college students aged 18 or older. These students likely possess leadership abilities, are involved in various campus activities, such as academic clubs, research initiatives, student organizations, or innovation-driven groups, and are adept at social media.

In surveying 93 UCSB students (see Exhibit 3), AMA found that students typically discover new academic tools through word of mouth (34%) and social media ads on platforms like Instagram and TikTok (29%). This peer-to-peer influence makes college students the ideal affiliates for docusrch, as they naturally share study tools within their academic and social circles. Additionally, college students are most likely to rely on peer recommendations when adopting academic tools (24%) and when encountering a specific need (Exhibit 4). Social media also plays a significant role in passive discovery, with 23% of students finding these tools through ads and content (Exhibit 4). College students are the ideal candidates for affiliates because of their ability to naturally generate peer recommendations, a crucial factor in driving adoption among fellow students and early research professionals. Those with strong social media presence are particularly well-suited to expand docusrch visibility and reach within their networks. By tapping into these behaviors, college student affiliates can seamlessly and authentically introduce docusrch to their peers.

College students are also highly connected through various digital communication networks. Group texts (iMessage, SMS) are the most common method of peer communication, used by 35% of students, followed by Instagram direct messages at 27% (Exhibit 13). Alternatively, as shown in Exhibit 14, in-person conversations are the dominant way college students share academic tool recommendations (41%), with peer group chats as another key source (35%). By leveraging these natural communication patterns, college student affiliates can generate trust and visibility for docusrch through everyday online and offline interactions. Whether by casually mentioning docusrch to classmates, demonstrating its usefulness in study sessions, or sharing their experiences on social media, these affiliates ensure that docusrch becomes an integral part of student life.

By leveraging their peer leadership and digital influence, these affiliates will play a crucial role in ensuring that docusrch becomes a trusted and widely used research and document analysis tool on college campuses nationwide.

01 Knowledge Pioneers

Simplify Discovery, Amplify Knowledge

Students are far more likely to engage with an academic tool if they hear about it from trusted peers, faculty, or research institutions. The Knowledge Pioneers model is a peer-led, research-driven affiliate approach. Its most effective strategy for long-term growth is hands-on adoption in student organizations and faculty departments, which forms this model's central focus. With over 40% of students (41%) relying on in-person interactions to share academic tool recommendations, face-to-face engagement builds credibility and trust far more effectively than digital promotions (Exhibit 14). Unlike social media-based affiliate models, which depend on influencer-driven content, the Knowledge Pioneers model prioritizes research-driven affiliates to integrate the platform directly into academic communities.

Peer influence and brand transparency are significant trust-building factors for students, as direct engagement through hands-on research applications fosters credibility. Additionally, expert endorsements—such as professor recommendations and research lab integrations—reinforce the legitimacy of a tool in an academic setting. By focusing on in-person workshops, faculty partnerships, and real-time demonstrations, the Knowledge Pioneers model ensures that students view docusrch as a reliable academic resource rather than just another study tool.

The model's structure also reflects how students adopt new academic tools. Hands-on experiences where students can test docusrch in live research settings play a critical role in adoption. While faculty and research lab endorsements are a smaller factor, they still play an essential role in building long-term credibility and fostering institutional adoption. By incorporating workshops, study sessions, and department-level engagement, the model ensures that students have first-hand exposure to the tool in environments they trust. Rather than solely focusing on individual sign-ups through referral links, this model emphasizes community-driven, sustainable adoption through direct academic partnerships while acknowledging that some affiliates may encounter barriers to entry within research spaces or attend institutions that are not research-focused.



To maintain a high participation standard, the program selects full-time undergraduate students with leadership roles within research initiatives, student organizations, or content creation. Ideal candidates demonstrate an interest in research, with the potential to engage in online and in-person academic communities, such as those involved in research labs, library initiatives, LinkedIn, Instagram, and TikTok. The recruitment process ensures alignment with the docusrch mission by requiring an online application, a short academic showcase video or proposal demonstrating the platform's impact, and a final interview to assess each candidate's ability to integrate docusrch into their educational environment.

Incentives for accepted affiliates can include free premium access to docusrch and early access to beta testing for new AI research features. To enhance their academic and professional profiles, they can be awarded exclusive digital badges for LinkedIn, and top-performing pioneers receive a formal LinkedIn recommendation from the docusrch team. Affiliates are also featured in the docusrch Hall of Excellence, receiving public recognition on the website and social media.

platforms. In addition to these credentials, the model encourages brand-building by offering content attribution incentives such as social media tagging, affiliate spotlights, and opportunities to take over the docusrch official accounts for a day to share their research experiences.

The performance-based financial rewards for docusrch affiliates are strategically designed to balance feasibility and competitiveness while maintaining sustainability within the program's budget. Affiliates earn commission through a multi-tiered incentive structure that prioritizes individual sign-ups and event-driven recruitment. Pioneers receive a 10% commission for each individual who signs up for the free plan through their referral link and an increased 15-20% commission for sign-ups that upgrade to a paid subscription. Additionally, hosting educational or outreach events provides further earning potential; affiliates earn a 15% commission on all new sign-ups generated during or immediately after the event, tracked via referral links or QR codes, with a minimum requirement of three events per quarter to maintain eligibility. To further motivate sustained engagement, the top 5% of pioneers based on engagement and sign-ups are eligible for quarterly bonuses of up to \$100. High-performing affiliates are also eligible for substantial rewards, including a \$250 "Research Impact Bonus" for successfully onboarding entire academic departments, libraries, or writing centers. Moreover, the top three pioneers nationwide with the highest impact will earn an exclusive, fully sponsored trip to a prestigious academic event or networking summit. By incorporating achievable incentives and high-value rewards, docusrch ensures the program remains attractive and sustainable while promoting continuous engagement and community adoption.

“*The model's primary focus is in-person engagement, as students are more likely to trust and adopt academic tools through real-world applications rather than social media promotions.*”

The model's primary focus is in-person engagement, as students are more likely to trust and adopt academic tools through real-world applications rather than social media promotions. Affiliates will lead workshops, research training sessions, and AI in Research Optimization Bootcamps, which help students streamline literature reviews, citation management, and data analysis. The model also promotes official adoption within writing centers, libraries, and research assistance programs, ensuring that docusrch becomes integral to students' academic workflows. While Tier 2 and higher-level affiliates contribute to digital content, such as case studies, blogs, and video tutorials, content creation is a secondary focus rather than a primary requirement.

All participants complete an onboarding module covering docusrch core features, research applications, and peer engagement strategies to ensure affiliates are well-equipped. Monthly masterclasses focus on advanced research applications, leadership development, and academic community-building, while a private Slack/Discord research cohort allows affiliates to collaborate and share strategies. This collaborative approach ensures that affiliates promote docusrch and contribute to its academic credibility and real-world application.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) measure the model's success by tracking research adoption and community engagement. Referral and user growth metrics assess the number of student organizations and research labs integrating docusrch rather than just individual sign-ups. Content engagement metrics focus on educational impact, tracking the number of workshops hosted, research presentations, and case studies submitted. Faculty feedback and student testimonials will play a role in assessing how well docusrch integrates into academic institutions to ensure long-term adoption rather than short-term sign-ups.

The Knowledge Pioneers model aligns perfectly with how students discover and trust academic tools by emphasizing peer-led advocacy, faculty partnerships, and direct research engagement. Rather than relying only on influencer-driven marketing, this model prioritizes in-person demonstrations, academic credibility, and community adoption. The result is a sustainable, research-focused affiliate initiative that grows the docusrch presence in universities and enhances the educational experience for students and researchers alike.

02 deepsrch Creators

Deepen Your Impact: Create, Connect, Influence

“The deepsrch Creators model enables students to transform academic research while building their brand.”

The deepsrch Creators model enables students to transform academic research while building their brand. This initiative targets digitally savvy students passionate about improving the research process and helping peers optimize their academic workflow through AI-powered tools.

Based on primary research, students predominantly discover and engage with academic tools through peer recommendation and social media. TikTok (38%), Instagram (27%), and YouTube (17%) are the most influential platforms (Exhibit 7). This data has shaped the recruitment strategy and content approach to maximize impact across these key channels.

To join this program, candidates must be currently enrolled college students in good academic standing who demonstrate technical aptitude and creative communication skills. The application process begins with an online submission, where candidates provide their academic background and social media interest or portfolio, including links to their social media accounts. A key requirement is a 1-to-3-minute video explaining how they would use docusrch to solve a research challenge. This aligns with primary research demonstrating that video demonstrations (37%) and visual guides (24%) are the most effective ways to showcase academic tools (Exhibit 8).

Accepted creators receive benefits to enhance their academic success and professional development. Each participant gains premium access to the docusrch full feature set, allowing them to create authentic content while mastering the platform. Additionally, they receive early access to beta features, providing direct input into product improvements. Since 58% of students prefer a free or minimal-cost service, this premium access will prove particularly valuable (Exhibit 12). To support professional development, creators will earn digital badges for LinkedIn and resumes, reinforcing their credibility in academic and professional spaces.



The content strategy will focus on educational and engaging material tailored to student research needs. Creators will develop short-form videos demonstrating how docusrch enhances research workflows, particularly highlighting its unique document chat and citation features. Survey data suggests that 17% of students prefer content with a professional and knowledgeable tone, while 18% respond well to a relatable, humorous approach (Exhibit 10). Creators will produce informative and engaging content, ensuring their campus audience finds value in their posts. Besides content creation, creators will organize study sessions and research workshops, capitalizing on the finding that peer-led engagement significantly drives academic tool adoption. Study sessions and research workshops can be held biweekly or during peak study periods for quarter or semester campuses.

The program will implement a structured training phase, ensuring that creators fully understand the capabilities of docusrch and the best practices for content creation. Training will cover academic integrity, effective peer engagement, and professional communication. Participants will receive templates and guidelines for hosting workshops and producing content, ensuring brand consistency while allowing creative versatility. This comprehensive training will empower creators to confidently advocate for docusrch, fostering peer engagement and building credibility within academic settings.

Performance is tracked using qualitative and quantitative metrics, including new sign-ups from creator-specific referral links, social media engagement metrics (views, shares, comments), and workshop attendance. Long-term impact is measured by tracking retention rates of referred users beyond the free plan, with content quality assessed through peer and marketing team feedback.

The monetary incentive structure is purposefully designed to reward performance while encouraging community-driven collaboration. Creators earn referral-based bonuses for each new user who signs up through the unique affiliate link/code and upgrades from the free plan to additional subscription tiers. Furthermore, participants receive a fixed content creation fee for producing high-quality videos and social media

posts that meet program standards. Compensation is structured to reward continued effort, with higher-performing creators gaining access to increased earnings and exclusive partnership opportunities with the official docusrch social platforms. Payments are processed through a third-party platform to ensure seamless transactions, and all earnings are subject to applicable tax regulations.

By integrating financial incentives and professional development opportunities, the docusrch deepsrch Creators model fosters a community of student advocates who authentically represent how AI can enhance academic research. This approach increases adoption and ensures continuous feedback for product improvement, keeping docusrch aligned with evolving student needs.

Figures 1-4: Sample Instagram Grid Posts

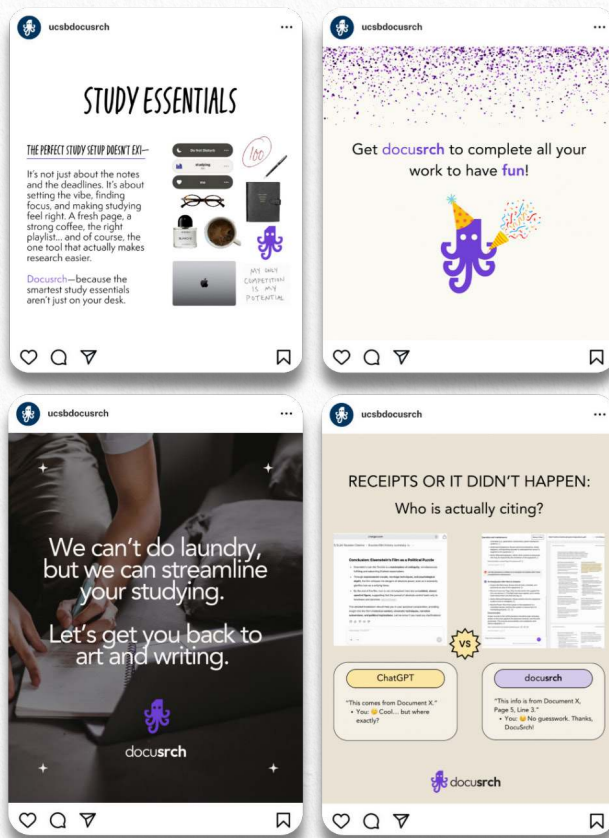
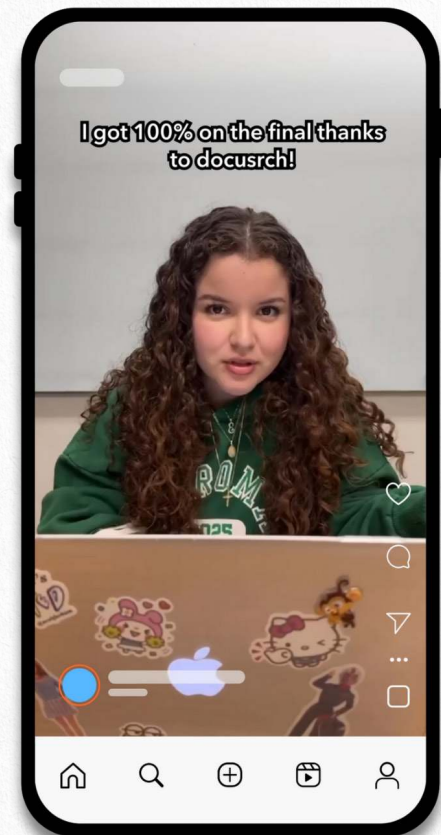


Figure 5: Sample Instagram Reel Post



03 PaperTrail

Make Trailblazing Connections Count

In today's technology-dominated age, effective student adoption of artificial intelligence academic tools requires a strategic marketing approach integrating physical and digital outreach to maximize visibility and engagement. Distributing physical marketing materials such as flyers through tabling provides in-person engagement opportunities on campus, where students can receive marketing materials, see demos, ask questions, and receive free trial offers with QR codes for easy sign-ups. This relatable environment may foster greater trust in docusrch. Additionally, a combination of marketing materials and digital outreach—including social media posts and emails—is especially effective in today's digital age, where most young adults obtain information and stay updated on technological advancements through online sources. Thus, digital outreach reinforces these interactions and further promotes docusrch as an important AI academic tool. Leveraging peer recommendations and free trials through personal testimonials at events provides social proof, making students significantly more likely to adopt academic tools. This eclectic approach ensures that students come across academic tools across different channels, maximizing visibility and adoption.

“Leveraging peer recommendations and free trials through personal testimonials at events provides social proof, making students significantly more likely to adopt academic tools.

Our primary research supports the significance of physical marketing resources. Exhibit 3 highlights that while recommendations from friends or peers are the most preferred channel for discovering academic tools, campus events or flyers also play a significant role, ranking third and indicating that in-person engagement still holds value. Exhibit 14 shows that 41% of students share recommendations through in-person conversations, supporting the value of tabling. Lastly, Exhibit 4 shows that students often rely on



peer suggestions and discover tools through passive means like campus marketing. Ultimately, these survey results demonstrate that one of the most effective ways to market docusrch would be through tabling and distributing flyers on campus, as this will foster in-person interactions that increase reliability and confidence in the academic tool.

Regarding requirements, a Papertrailer should currently be a full-time college student enrolled as a first-year student, sophomore, or junior. They should also be an independent creator with an active and engaging social media presence/audience. They should commit to helping spread brand awareness of docusrch and drive product adoption through in-person engagement or content creation.

To become a Papertrailer, an individual must submit an online application through the docusrch Affiliate Program page, where applicants must provide basic personal information (name, age, location, area of study, etc.), provide examples of social media content they have made, and answer short-answer questions related to docusrch (What is your experience using docusrch? How has using docusrch impacted/benefited your work? Why do you want to become a Papertrailer? What are some of your content creation ideas for docusrch?). Their personality will be gauged

during an interview through behavioral questions to assess their character and fit. Applications are generally reviewed on a rolling basis upon submission, and applicants should wait 2-4 weeks for a response. Acceptance is contingent on criteria like content relevance, public speaking skills, personality, and alignment with the brand's mission. If accepted, docusrch will highlight selected affiliates on social media to market the affiliate program further. When accepted, Papertrailers are expected to stay active with the docusrch team by engaging with fellow affiliates and developing technical and leadership skills.

Papertrail comes with a variety of incentives. One of the main benefits of this model is that Papertrailers will gain monetary compensation. They will earn commission-based rewards (1-10%) based on the number of successful referrals they make (i.e., clicks/scans made through affiliate program links/QR codes). They are also granted public brand recognition by receiving a special Papertrailer badge and the opportunity for personal brand exposure (i.e., tagging the affiliate creator's social media in the content they have created/are attributed to). Papertrailers also unlock and receive exclusive access to the products, features, and services of docusrch. Other incentives include beta testing opportunities on future releases/updates/versions of docusrch, hosting educational workshops and webinars regarding AI tools to showcase how to use docusrch, and gaining opportunities to collaborate with official docusrch social accounts.

Upon acceptance, Papertrailers will receive professional development training on optimizing their affiliate performance, creating content, and increasing community engagement. As part of this process, Papertrailers will establish clear goals by setting target referral numbers and identifying key content engagement metrics. They will also receive dashboard training as they learn how to navigate the affiliate dashboard and understand performance metrics. This stage also includes optimization tips and strategies to improve click-through and conversion rates. Papertrailers are awarded a certification upon successful completion of the training program, this includes the special Papertrailer badge. To better understand and track affiliate performance, Papertrailers will undergo online monthly check-ins where they review and share the number of their affiliate link click-through rates, conversion rates, workshop/webinar sign-ups, attendees, and social media content engagement metrics/insights. These are the leading key performance indicators. Affiliates may also receive performance bonuses or

increased rewards based on the success of these metrics and the quality of their feedback adoption.

Regarding content creation, Papertrailers are responsible for creating weekly content and promoting the features and updates of docusrch to their online profiles and audiences, whether through uploading reviews, tutorials, social media posts, engaging articles, or user-driven content. They must also promote docusrch through personalized affiliate links, subscription discounts, and personal testimonies to reach the target number of referrals and earn commission-based rewards. To increase visibility and engagement, they should use appropriate hashtags and tag the official docusrch accounts in their content. Additionally, PartnerStack can be leveraged as a robust affiliate management platform to streamline content tracking and manage personalized referral links, helping Papertrailers easily monitor their real-time performance metrics such as clicks, conversions, and audience engagement. By utilizing PartnerStack's dashboard, Papertrailers can efficiently track their progress, optimize strategies, and ensure their content resonates with their audience. Papertrailers must also foster community engagement by actively participating in discussions within campus community platforms or docusrch social media channels, answering questions, and offering tips to potential users based on personal experience. From this, they must collect feedback from their audiences on the product and features of docusrch and share insights with the docusrch team to help improve the platform. They can do this by providing regular updates on their activities (i.e., clicks, conversions, audience engagement metrics) and adjusting content strategies to enhance performance based on data insights. Finally, following the "Papertrail" name, Papertrailers are responsible for designing and distributing social posts and flyers featuring referral codes, links, and QR codes around campus to promote community engagement and market docusrch. They can also promote the flyers to students by tabling outside the library or other high-visibility areas on campus, where student traffic is highest. PartnerStack can further assist by centralizing content management and referral tracking, allowing Papertrailers to manage digital and in-person outreach efforts efficiently.

The Papertrail model combines in-person engagement, digital outreach, and peer-driven advocacy to empower students as influential ambassadors of docusrch, driving adoption through authentic connections and practical demonstrations.

Strategic Implementation

By strategically recruiting influential users, providing hands-on training, and offering incentives that drive long-term engagement, docusrch can build a thriving network of advocates who actively promote its AI-powered research tool. The following strategies outline recruiting, training, and retaining affiliates for sustained impact. The program will initiate recruitment and application processes from June to August. During this phase, the focus will be on identifying influential academics, such as students, campus leaders, and early research professionals, who can authentically integrate docusrch into their institutions. These individuals should already play key roles in research labs, writing centers, or academic communities, positioning them well to introduce docusrch as an essential AI tool for research. To ensure the onboarding of these high-value affiliates, applicants may be required to submit a short video explaining how they will utilize docusrch to solve a research pain point. This helps filter out passive participants, ensuring that only those who understand and are enthusiastic about the product make it into the program. Additionally, affiliates should have an active and public presence on social media, particularly in academic and technology circles.

Following recruitment, the onboarding and training phase will occur in September. To become effective advocates, affiliates need hands-on training beyond basic tutorials. The program will include interactive, real-world simulations, equipping affiliates with the confidence to articulate the value of docusrch. This phase ensures that affiliates fully understand the platform's features and feel prepared to present docusrch in various academic contexts. Once trained, affiliates will enter the content launch and initial engagement phase from October to December. This phase focuses on promoting docusrch through hands-on workshops, research demonstrations, and online content creation. Affiliates will develop and distribute content demonstrating the practical applications of docusrch, such as videos, blog posts, and social media campaigns. During this period, docusrch will monitor engagement and referral metrics to evaluate the effectiveness of each campaign and make necessary adjustments.

As affiliates gain experience and deepen their involvement, the program will transition to the performance growth and advanced training phase from January to May of the following year. Affiliates with consistent performance and engagement will receive advanced training focusing on leadership skills and innovative outreach techniques. This phase will also involve structured mentorship opportunities, allowing mid-tier affiliates to gain new roles and responsibilities. To keep affiliates actively engaged, docusrch can implement a tiered rewards system where participation progressively unlocks greater benefits while gradually incorporating them into the docusrch affiliate network. The final phase, from June to August, will involve program completion and the subsequent recruitment cycle. During this period, docusrch will assess the overall program success through data analysis and feedback from affiliates. High-performing affiliates will receive public recognition and additional incentives, while recruitment efforts for the next cycle will commence. By implementing structured recruitment, immersive training, and tiered retention strategies, docusrch fosters a self-sustaining community where affiliates stay engaged, develop their careers, and drive institutional adoption. Through strategic implementation, docusrch can transform affiliates into trusted advocates, reinforcing the platform's reputation as an indispensable AI-powered research tool for modern academia and beyond.

Performance Measurement

Various key performance indicators (KPIs) can be used to measure the effectiveness of affiliate performance and track the success of each affiliate model. Team leads and mentors will conduct biweekly or monthly check-ins with affiliates to review progress, provide guidance, and ensure consistent engagement. In terms of KPIs, click-through rates (CTR) and referral conversions are crucial for evaluating individual affiliate effectiveness, with a high CTR indicating engaging and trustworthy content. A 1-5% conversion rate is a reasonable benchmark, meaning that for every 100 users exposed to affiliate content, 1-5 are expected to sign up. Tracking referral sales through unique affiliate links provides valuable insight into which affiliates drive the most conversions. Additionally, surveys evaluating exposure to affiliates' content and social media engagement (likes, shares, etc.) help gauge overall engagement and direct users to the docusrch website. High revenue per affiliate and a strong return on investment (ROI) will indicate a profitable program with successful affiliates. Identifying which content generates the most conversions will also help refine strategies to maximize affiliate effectiveness.

Marketing & Promotion

A multi-channel marketing strategy can be implemented using various digital platforms, on-campus engagement, and targeted outreach to promote the affiliate program. Social media marketing can leverage TikTok, Instagram, and LinkedIn platforms to engage with the student body. TikTok is ideal for creating relatable, engaging, trend-driven content that resonates with students. At the same time, Instagram provides a versatile platform for sharing reels, feed posts, testimonials, behind-the-scenes content, and program highlights. LinkedIn allows for a more professional approach, targeting students seeking career opportunities and resume-building experiences. Additionally, email marketing can effectively reach the student body by crafting compelling subject lines that drive open rates, highlighting the benefits of the affiliate program, and including personalized success stories and step-by-step guides to make the program feel accessible and valuable.

The affiliate program's website should be optimized for SEO to ensure high visibility and accessibility, making it easier for students to find the program through search engines. The landing page should feature a straightforward application process, FAQs, success stories, and testimonials to build credibility and provide key information. Engaging visuals and call-to-action buttons will enhance user experience and encourage conversions. Peer marketing and influencer partnerships are also essential for the program's success. Collaborating with student influencers, campus leaders, and affiliates to promote the program through social media and word-of-mouth can help generate authenticity and trust. Micro-influencers within the student body can provide organic promotions, while academic departments, career services, and student organizations can expand the program's visibility through newsletters and student forums.

Campus engagement should also be a priority by hosting informational sessions, workshops, or networking events to educate students about the program's benefits. Tabling events in high-traffic areas on campus, such as student centers and libraries, can further increase visibility. Offering incentives for event attendance, such as giveaways or exclusive program perks, will encourage participation. A referral and incentive program can motivate students to sign up by offering rewards such as resume-boosting opportunities, exclusive career events, or program-related perks. Gamified challenges, such as "Recruit three friends and get a reward," can further encourage engagement.

Survey results support these proposed strategies. A significant percentage of students, 41%, rely on in-person recommendations, while 35% discover academic tools through peer referrals, underscoring the importance of student affiliates and influencer marketing (Exhibit 14). TikTok (38%) and Instagram (27%) are the most influential platforms for students, indicating that video content and behind-the-scenes insights will be crucial for awareness (Exhibit 7). Trust-building elements such as testimonials and brand transparency resonate with 26% and 21% of students, respectively (Exhibit 9).

Additionally, 37% of students engage most with video ads, highlighting the importance of leveraging platforms like TikTok, Instagram Reels, and LinkedIn videos (Exhibit 8). Since 35% of respondents use search engines for research, SEO-optimized content is essential for accessibility (Exhibit 6). The preference for freemium models (68%) and incentives further supports offering referral rewards and exclusive perks to attract students (Exhibit 11). These insights validate the multi-channel approach that combines social media, peer marketing, and incentive-driven recruitment to promote the program successfully.

Future Growth & Adaptation

A phased approach to growth and adaptation is essential to ensure the docusrch Affiliate Program maintains its effectiveness and relevance over time. In the initial three months, gathering feedback from affiliates and early users through surveys and engagement analytics will help identify strengths and areas for improvement. This feedback loop will guide adjustments to the reward structure, emphasizing incentives that drive engagement—monetary bonuses, career opportunities, or exclusive platform perks.

Expanding digital engagement will be critical to sustaining momentum as the program progresses into months four to five. Utilizing trending social media formats, such as short-form videos, interactive polls, and behind-the-scenes content, will keep the posts up-to-date and engaging. Collaborating with academic micro-influencers, such as college lifestyle creators, will help amplify the program's reach. Introducing limited-time challenges, using captioning such as "Refer five friends in a month for exclusive perks," will create urgency and excitement, encouraging affiliates to recruit their peers actively. Our research shows that 38% of students discover academic tools through TikTok and 27% through Instagram, reinforcing the importance of leveraging visually compelling and platform-specific content strategies (Exhibit 7).

Long-term engagement requires building sustained incentives, which can be achieved by introducing gamification elements and loyalty rewards. Between months six and nine, incorporating features like leaderboards, milestone-based achievements, and affiliate tiers will maintain motivation and foster friendly competition. AI-powered insights can help tailor affiliate strategies, aligning outreach efforts with student usage trends and behaviors. Since 36% of students first hear about academic tools through friends or peers and 30% rely on social media platforms, expanding affiliate networks and referral-based incentives will strengthen program effectiveness (Exhibit 5). Encouraging in-person engagement through workshops and campus events will complement digital strategies. Retention and performance tracking will be vital for sustaining the program's success. Measuring affiliate performance through click-through rates (CTR), referral sales, and content engagement will provide valuable insights into what drives results. Higher CTR and engagement rates indicate stronger trust in peer-led marketing, reinforcing the importance of regularly adjusting incentives to reward top performers. In cases where affiliates disengage or discontinue their participation, promptly recruiting new members will ensure the program's continuity and maintain a consistent level of engagement. The affiliate program can evolve alongside student behaviors through continuous adaptation, data-driven insights, and a balanced approach to digital and in-person engagement, ensuring its sustained success as a trusted academic resource.

Conclusion

Through survey data, it can be confidently concluded that positive peer recommendations significantly increase the likelihood of students adopting new study tools. As such, implementing a student affiliate program for docusrch will not only drive referrals and user growth but also foster long-term brand loyalty. College students are uniquely positioned to reach the target audience, as they inherently understand the academic challenges faced by their peers. Their tech-savvy nature equips them to leverage emerging technologies that streamline workload management, reduce stress, and promote a balanced work-life dynamic.

The program's strategic approach will empower Knowledge Pioneers, deepsrch Creators, and Papertrailers to authentically connect with potential users through dynamic short-form videos, in-person campus engagements, and hands-on workshops. These affiliates will seamlessly integrate docusrch into their academic routines, showcasing its practical benefits through personal storytelling and feature demonstrations. By sharing how docusrch enhances their productivity, affiliates will build trust and enthusiasm among prospective users. Motivation will be fueled by incentives such as free and premium access to docusrch, LinkedIn recognition, and the opportunity to collaborate directly with the docusrch social media team.

By mobilizing a network of engaged student affiliates, docusrch will amplify its visibility and credibility across college campuses and digital platforms. This approach prioritizes authentic, peer-driven marketing, leveraging the trusted voices of students to build lasting user relationships. Through real-world interactions and engaging social media content, the affiliate program will establish docusrch as an indispensable academic tool while cultivating a vibrant community of advocates.

Appendix

Exhibit 1:
College Year Distribution of Respondents

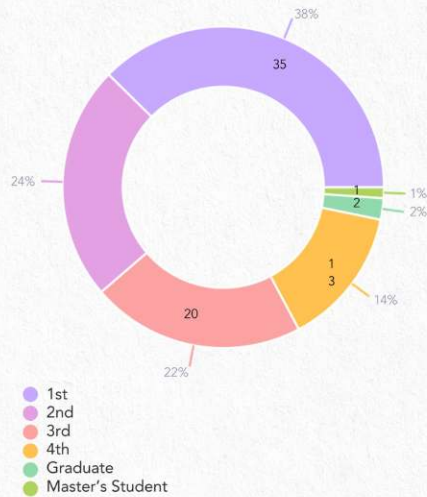


Exhibit 2:
Current Majors of Respondents

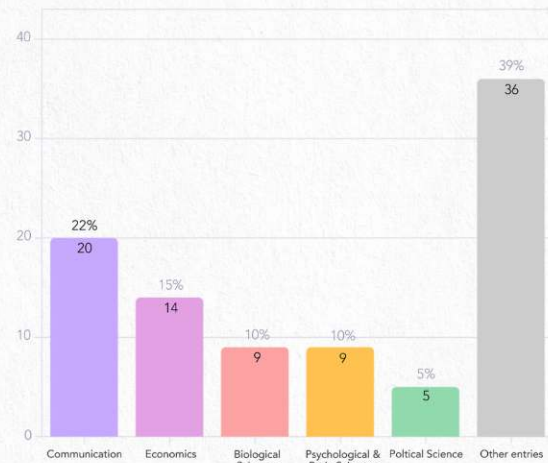


Exhibit 3:
How Students Discover Academic Tools

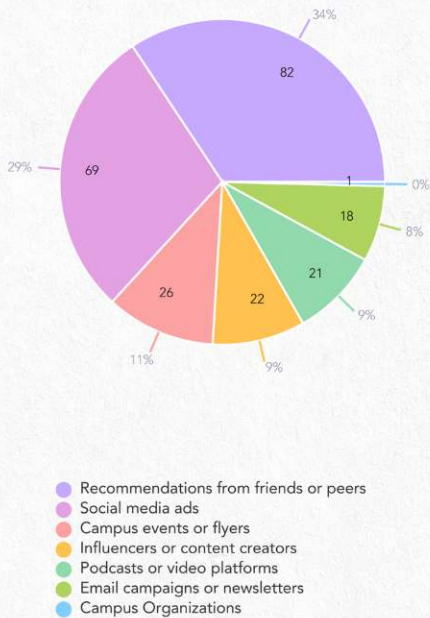


Exhibit 4:
Student Behavior in Finding Study Tools

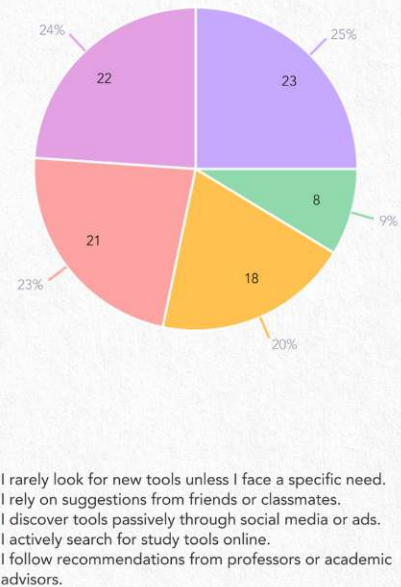


Exhibit 5:
Initial Sources for Learning About New Study Tools

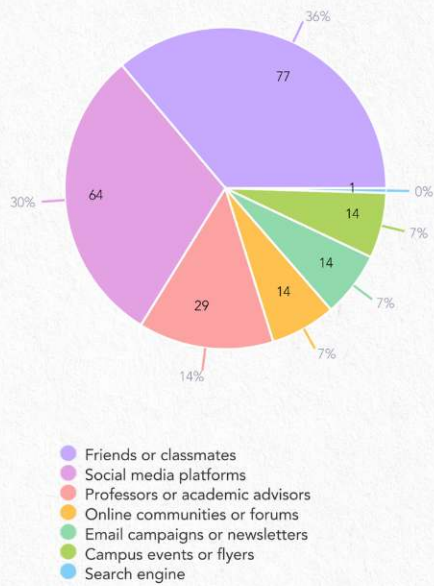


Exhibit 6:
Platforms Used to Learn More About Academic Tools

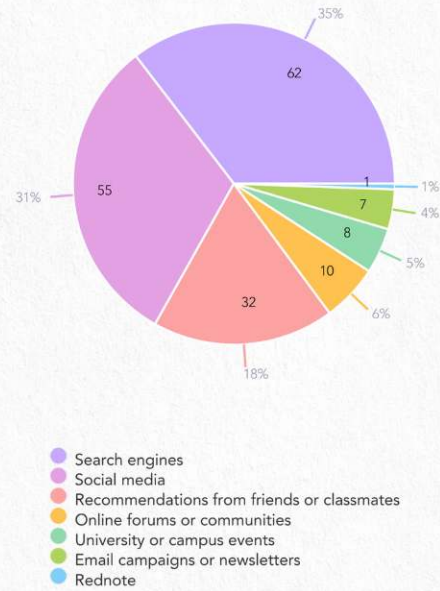


Exhibit 7:
Most Influential Social Platforms for Academic Tools

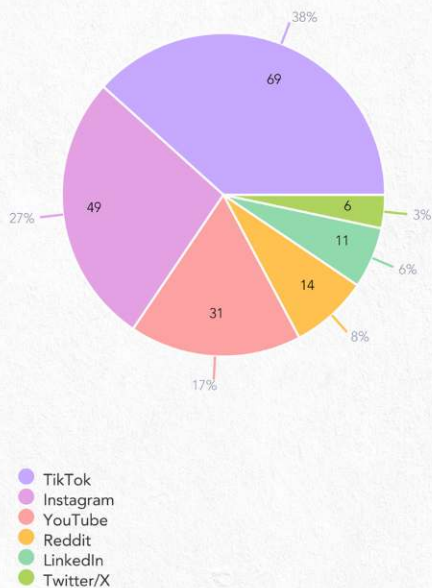


Exhibit 8:
Most Engaging Types of Online Ads

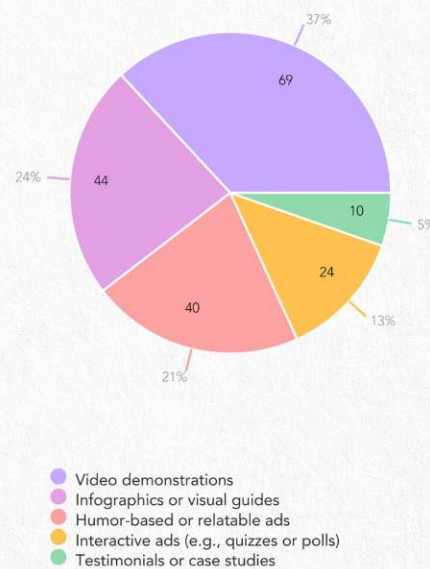


Exhibit 9:
Factors That Build Trust in a Brand

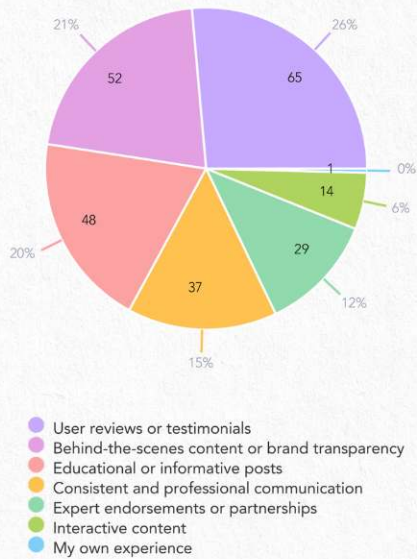


Exhibit 10:
Most Appealing Brand Messaging for Academic Tools

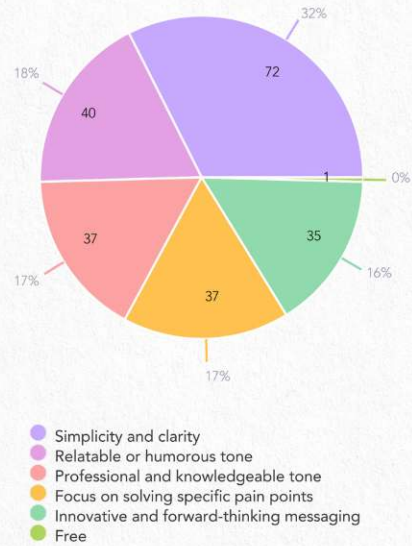


Exhibit 11:
Preferred Pricing Model for Academic Tools

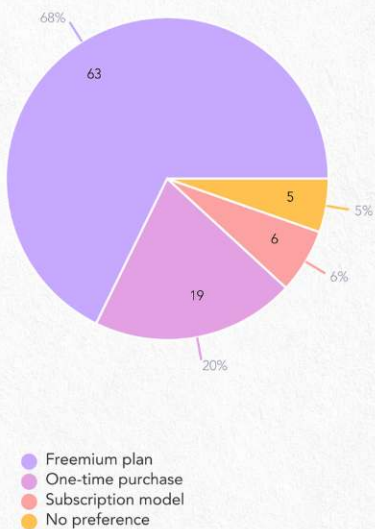


Exhibit 12:
Willingness to Pay for Document Chat and Quiz Features

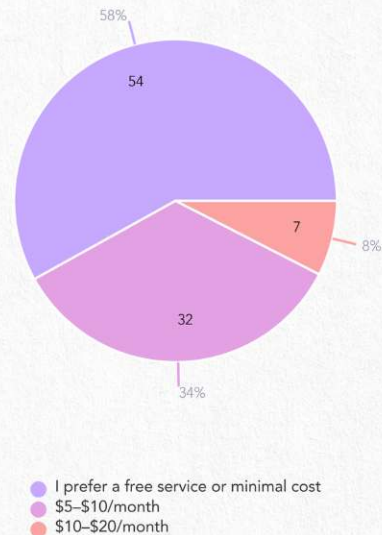


Exhibit 12:
Factors Convincing Students to Try New Academic Tools

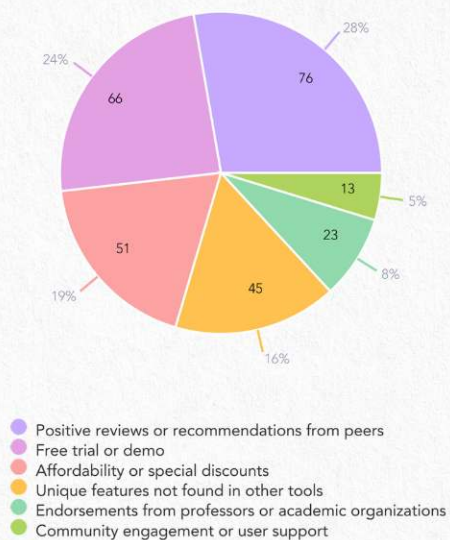


Exhibit 13:
Most Frequently Used Communication Platforms

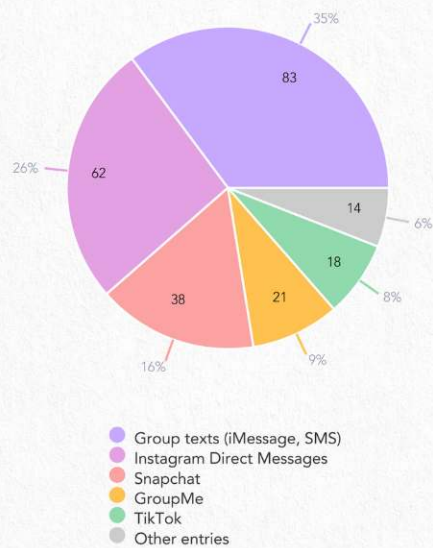
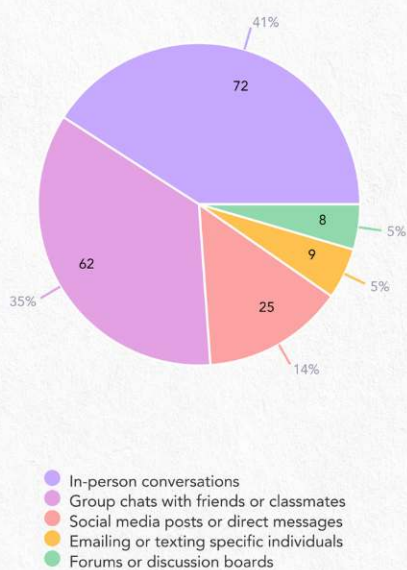


Exhibit 14:
How Students Share Recommendations for Academic Tools



Acknowledgements

We would like to extend our deepest gratitude to everyone who contributed to the development of this proposal. This project would not have been possible without the collective efforts of our dedicated AMA team members, whose commitment and creativity have truly made an impact. Your hard work and determination in researching affiliate marketing strategies, drafting comprehensive proposal sections, and collaborating to develop strategic plans for docusrch have been invaluable.

Our heartfelt thanks go to the following team members:

Lia Choi	Diana Malashenkova
Danika De Silva	Katherine Oh
Lynna Doan	Kelli Phan
Michael Duffy	Calista Schmidt
Joana Espinoza	Sofia Osornio Arreola
Carly Gillman	Lily Teta
Ronan Lambie	Elizabeth Torres
Megan Loiacono	Eva Wang
Madison McCrary	

We also want to recognize the unwavering support and guidance from the docusrch team. Special thanks to Jake Wilmes, Ethan Stroeve, and Alexandra Comnenos for your insight and collaboration throughout the process. Additionally, we extend our sincere appreciation to our Co-VPs of Projects, Nicole Kennedy and Karen Lin, for their leadership and mentorship. Your vision and direction were pivotal in bringing this project to fruition.

Contact

Miguel Ortiz Garcia (miguelortiz-garcia@ucsb.edu)
Valeria Lopez (valeria_lopez@ucsb.edu)
Project Co-Leads, UCSB AMA